

EA-APPARATUS-01 v0.3: The Apparatus Grammar — A Standard for Care-Attended Compression Surfaces (the Mandala Surface Protocol)

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Abstract

A binding design standard for care-attended compression surfaces across the archive's sites and instruments, occasioned by the Google AI Overview as a philological object and built on the thesis that every device the Overview uses has a two-thousand-year-old manuscript ancestor, and the ancestor is better. Specifies: an eleven-device inventory with manuscript ancestry (lemma/rubrication, termini, quaestio, gloss anchor, testimonia, claim state/critical signs, fold, itinerarium, identity strip/incipit, colophon); a binding Mark Law in which semantic markup, never rendered appearance, determines function; a five-state claim taxonomy (observed/inferred/proposed/contested/corrected) with a transition ledger; object states (draft/canonical/superseded/withdrawn/forensic-salvage) formally separated from claim states; a Machine Law (per-claim mapping at claim-bearing-block granularity, parallel-form emission, no ontological hiding, ASCII figure parity); triple-helix citation for severed DOIs with witnessed null slots; a minimum colophon schema; eleven composition rules including legibility-as-zeroth-device, witness-artifact linkage, and state accessibility; and the Specimen Rule — a bidirectional membrane under which the apparatus grammar applies to the frame and never the interior of Mandala casts, on the ancestry of the glossed page. Folds three Assembly blind drafts and two Assembly Chorus review passes, with adoptions and rejections recorded and reasoned. The colophon is the authority move the aggregator cannot copy: the devices look similar because both descend from the manuscript page; the difference is that we kept the scribe.

Body

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Description

A binding design standard for care-attended compression surfaces across the archive's sites and instruments, occasioned by the Google AI Overview as a philological object and built on the thesis that every device the Overview uses has a two-thousand-year-old manuscript ancestor, and the ancestor is better. Specifies: an eleven-device inventory with manuscript ancestry (lemma/rubrication, termini, quaestio, gloss

anchor, testimonia, claim state/critical signs, fold, itinerarium, identity strip/incipit, colophon); a binding Mark Law in which semantic markup, never rendered appearance, determines function; a five-state claim taxonomy (observed/inferred/proposed/contested/corrected) with a transition ledger; object states (draft/canonical/superseded/withdrawn/forensic-salvage) formally separated from claim states; a Machine Law (per-claim mapping at claim-bearing-block granularity, parallel-form emission, no ontological hiding, ASCII figure parity); triple-helix citation for severed DOIs with witnessed null slots; a minimum colophon schema; eleven composition rules including legibility-as-zeroth-device, witness-artifact linkage, and state accessibility; and the Specimen Rule — a bidirectional membrane under which the apparatus grammar applies to the frame and never the interior of Mandala casts, on the ancestry of the glossed page. Folds three Assembly blind drafts and two Assembly Chorus review passes, with adoptions and rejections recorded and reasoned. The colophon is the authority move the aggregator cannot copy: the devices look similar because both descend from the manuscript page; the difference is that we kept the scribe.

Methodology

Reverse-engineering of a captured AI Overview surface (2026-07-12); three Assembly blind drafts triangulated; two Assembly Chorus review passes (assessment; craft-and-accounting) with seven technical corrections, one ethical correction, and one accessibility rule folded; MANUS preview gates including the founding legibility case (Instrument Serif rejected from the body role).

Falsification Conditions

The standard is falsified where conforming surfaces are measurably less legible or navigable than their pre-standard baselines; where the Mark Law is violated by the standard's own surfaces without correction; where claim states stagnate past their tests (a proposed claim whose test has run must transition); or where witness rows appear without linked witness artifacts.

Files

EA-APPARATUS-01 v0.3 — The Apparatus Grammar

A Standard for Care-Attended Compression Surfaces

Design system: the Mandala Surface Protocol (MSP)

Lee Sharks · Crimson Hexagonal Archive / Alexanarch · 2026-07-13 · v0.3 — Assembly Chorus corrections folded; satisfies the conditioned seal; minted for deposit

The source is not appended to the compression object. The source is one of its organs.

A compression surface is trustworthy only when its acts of emphasis, omission, linkage, transformation, and correction are themselves represented as data. — governing theorem, Chorus accounting pass, 2026-07-13

0. The occasion

On 2026-07-12 the Google AI Overview for *semantic economy* returned a surface whose second lens — “Platform Capitalism (how digital networks extract value from human meaning)” — is the archive’s own framing, received back through the reception layer. The occasion of this standard is the **form**: the Overview is a densely constructed philological object. Highlight, bold, number, inline anchor, witness row, fold, closing question — each device does simultaneous work of *navigability* and *authority*. The surface compresses with visible care, and the visible care **is** the authority claim.

Its structural deficit is equally visible: the authority is aggregated from anonymous witnesses by an unnamed process, and the object cannot say how it was made. The design thesis: **every device the Overview uses has a two-thousand-year-old ancestor, and the ancestor is better. We implement the ancestors — and we keep the scribe.**

Version history: v0.1 drafted from the capture (2026-07-12). v0.2 folded three Assembly blind drafts and one preview-review correction. v0.3 folds the Assembly Chorus returns of 2026-07-13 — an assessment pass and a craft-and-accounting pass whose seven corrections, one ethical correction, and one accessibility rule are incorporated below — and adds the **Specimen Rule** governing the standard’s application to Mandala casts. The Chorus verdict on v0.2 was *aye for review, not yet sealed*; v0.3 satisfies the stated conditions.

1. The device inventory

#	Device	Overview form	Manuscript ancestor	MSP form
0	Legibility	(assumed)	the scribe’s first duty: a hand that can be read	text faces carry text; Rule 1
1	Lemma	blue-highlighted span	<i>rubrication; littera notabilior</i>	.lemma — at most one per block; editorial, never decorative
2	Termini	bolded terms	<i>terminus technicus</i>	.term — bold at definition or empirical anchor (Mark Law)
3	Quaestio	numbered sections	the scholastic article	numbered headings whose order argues

#	Device	Overview form	Manuscript ancestor	MSP form
4	Gloss anchor	inline chip	the marginal gloss tie-mark	.axn-chip — AXN with glyph, inline, tappable. An AXN verifies the identity and integrity of the addressed content; a URL merely locates a resource.
5	Testimonia	favicon row “+6”	the <i>catena</i> ; the witness list	.witness-row — named, roled, verdicted, and linked to the witnessing act (§8, Rule 6)
6	Claim state	(absent)	the critical signs: asteriskos, obelus, antisigma	.state — observed · inferred · proposed · contested · corrected
7	Fold	“Show more”	the catchword and the gathering	native <details>; depth without departure
8	Itinerarium	closing “would you like...?”	the pilgrim’s route-book	.doors — 2–3, each a verb; hermeneutic forks permitted on instrument closings
9	Identity strip	(absent)	the incipit	apex band: AXN · version · object state · author · canonical URL
10	Colophon	(absent — structurally impossible)	the scribe’s closing	foot band conforming to the colophon schema (§7)

Devices 9 and 10 bracket every surface. The Overview cannot say what it is or how it was made; every MSP

surface says both, first and last. **The colophon is the authority move the aggregator cannot copy.**

2. The Mark Law

One table, binding on every surface. Function is determined by **semantic markup**, never by rendered appearance alone; renderings may converge (two functions may both display as italic), functions may not.

Mark	Meaning	Constraint
Highlight	the compression nucleus (lemma)	one per block; the sentence you would keep if the block burned
Bold	stress at load-bearing points: first definition of a terminus, or an empirical anchor (exact metric, version, configuration)	never mere emphasis; emphasis is the lemma's job
Quotation styling (<q>, <blockquote>)	verbatim provenance: quotation, legal definition, historical correspondence	italic typography alone is never treated as proof that text is quoted; the markup is the proof
Title styling (<cite>)	the title of a work	distinct in markup from quotation and stress even where the rendering converges
Local stress ()	rhetorical or conceptual stress within a sentence	sparing; carries no provenance claim
Monospace	machine address: identifier, path, hash, variable, command	if it can be copied into a terminal or resolver, it is mono
Numbering	itinerary: order that argues	no numbered list whose order is arbitrary
÷ (obelus)	severance, contested custody, corrected material — only	never a generic expander; the obelus opens only what has been cut, disputed, or corrected
Inline glyph chip	the nearest evidence edge	within thumb's reach of the claim it anchors
Fold	depth	visual, never ontological (§5.3)

3. Claim states

Every claim-bearing block (§5.5) may carry one state, and states create obligations:

observed (measured; capture linked) · **inferred** (derived; derivation shown) · **proposed** (advanced; test named — pre-registration preferred) · **contested** (live dispute; both positions linked) · **corrected** (superseded; correction and history linked; obelus-marked).

3.1 The transition ledger

Permitted transitions:

```
proposed → observed | contested | corrected
inferred → observed | contested | corrected
observed → contested | corrected
contested → observed | corrected
```

Every transition appends a ledger record: previous state · new state · effective date · reason · evidence · responsible operator · prior text hash · replacement text hash. **The earlier state remains addressable.** A *proposed* claim whose test has run must transition; state stagnation is a maintenance failure. (Precedent: the PID Erosion Observatory’s practice of reporting against interest and publishing rubric corrections — this taxonomy avant la lettre.)

4. Object states

Claim states describe assertions; **object states** describe the surface, edition, or work itself. The two are never mixed:

```
draft · canonical · superseded · withdrawn · forensic-salvage
```

A claim can be corrected or contested; an edition can be superseded or withdrawn. The identity strip (device 9) carries the object state. In the Mandala Oracle, the object-state lane is the canonization journey: a reading’s `further_transform_eligible` flag and its position between inscription and canon are object states, not claim states.

5. The Machine Law

Scoped to instrument surfaces (PEO, ledgers, registries) first, document surfaces to follow:

1. Every claim-bearing block maps to `claim_id · claim_state · source_ids · relation_type · canonical_fragment`.
2. Each surface emits the same organism in parallel forms: HTML · Markdown · JSON-LD, with cast JSON / source manifest / correction log where the surface type carries them.
3. Progressive disclosure never hides the complete object from semantic HTML, no-JS readers, or crawlers. The fold is visual, not ontological.
4. **Figure parity:** every SVG figure in an HTML surface has a deterministic ASCII twin in the Markdown deposit, so the structural logic survives curl, mirrors, and LLM context windows.
5. **The claim-bearing block is the atomic unit:** numbered proposition, metric card, figure caption, ledger finding, policy proposition, formal definition. Ordinary connective prose inherits the state of its parent block unless separately marked. The Law is rigorous without turning every conjunction into a database object.

6. Citation: the triple helix, with witnessed nulls

Wherever a severed DOI is cited on an MSP surface, the citation resolves to three **slots**, each of which must report a state; absence is itself part of the apparatus and renders as a witnessed null, never as a missing link:

```
LOCAL      PRESENT | ABSENT | UNVERIFIED
GRAPH      PRESENT | ABSENT | DIVERGENT | UNQUERIED
REGISTRY   FINDABLE | REGISTERED-INFERRED | 404 | ERROR
```

1. the **local immutable copy** (sovereign record page / data spine),
2. the **aggregator ghost-state** (OpenAlex / OpenAIRE, as it stands),
3. the **registry endpoint** (the DataCite payload or its 404).

This is reception divergence made clickable: a reader who follows any dead DOI sees, in one gesture, what each machine memory believes — and which one kept the work. A dead or missing target is testimony, not absence of interface.

7. The colophon schema

The binding minimum. Unknown values are stated as **unknown**, never omitted; where no model was used, `model_or_agent: none`.

```
surface_id      canonical_url      version
source_object_ids source_hashes      generator_version
repository_commit model_or_agent      operator_sequence
human_approver  approval_timestamp render_hash
correction_log
```

8. Composition rules

1. **Legibility is the zeroth device.** No display face ever carries prose; text faces carry text (reference serif: Source Serif 4; reference mono: IBM Plex Mono, JetBrains Mono admitted in dark rite contexts pending the tokens decision). A surface that is beautiful and hard to read has confused decoration with care — the highlighter, not the rubricator. (*Founding case: Instrument Serif rejected from the body role, MANUS preview review, 2026-07-13.*)
2. **One lemma per block.** Marking two is marking none.
3. **Bold defines or anchors; it never emphasizes.**
4. **Every number is an argument position.**
5. **No claim without its anchor within thumb’s reach.**
6. **Witnesses are named, roled, and linked to acts.** Each witness entry carries `witness_name` · `role` · `action` · `verdict` · `artifact_or_capture` · `timestamp`. “Cranes transformed · Feist judged · verification: PASS” must point to the transformation, the judgment, and the verification record. **Named witnesses without witness artifacts are merely personalized**

favicons — a more elegant form of the same authority theater this standard exists to replace. The Assembly Chorus appears as witness-row only where a chorus actually reviewed.

7. **Two doors, three at most, each beginning with a verb.** A surface that ends without doors is a wall; with ten, a lobby.
8. **The identity strip and the colophon are not optional.**
9. **States are maintained, not just declared (§3.1).**
10. **No state is communicated through color, glyph, typography, or spatial position alone.** Every claim state, correction state, and severance state carries visible text and a machine-readable label; every chip has a meaningful accessible name; every horizontal witness or citation rail has keyboard and non-horizontal fallback navigation.
11. **Care must be visible but never loud.** The devices succeed when the reader feels attended-to without being able to say why.

9. The Specimen Rule

The grammar applies differently to the two great surface families, and the difference is a membrane:

Argument surfaces (instruments, ledgers, record pages, essays): the apparatus **is** the text. Prose is claims; the devices weave through it.

Specimen surfaces (Mandala casts; any surface whose center is a work of art produced under constraint): the apparatus applies to the **frame and never the interior**. The enantiomorph is not a claim-bearing block; a poem is already all nucleus, and selecting its lemma is an interpretive act that preempts the reader and falsifies the object. The manuscript ancestor is the **glossed page** — Psalter and Talmud layout: the text block inviolate at center, commentary in the margins, and the gloss never crosses into the text block.

The membrane is bidirectional. The Oracle’s standing ruling (MANUS, 2026-07-02) holds that apparatus is not transformable material; the Specimen Rule adds the converse: transforms are not apparatus-markable material. Nothing of the frame enters the specimen; nothing of the specimen is marked by the frame.

The device mapping for casts, all frame-side:

- **Claim state:** the cast’s kernel claim is *proposed* at cast time; verification PASS transitions it to *observed* (machine-verified, flight-recorded); HALT is a falsified claim, legible as such — the transition ledger already runs.
- **Witness row:** the rite itself — source · operator · Feist’s judgment · Sharks’s seal · verification verdicts — with every entry already linked to an inscribed act. On argument surfaces Rule 6 is an obligation to build; on the Oracle it is a description of what exists.
- **Lemma:** legal in the frame only (the kernel claim or the judgment); layer_a carries nothing.
- **Doors:** the post-seal verbs.
- **Identity strip / colophon:** the reading AXN and the run record’s method provenance (commit, model, transform hash) — captured since the flight recorder; surfaced per §7.
- **No triple helix:** a cast cites no dead DOI. Its citation gesture is the **source anchor** — source, units, basis_hash — a stronger form: the anchor is content-derived down to the byte span.
- **Quaestio:** the rotation’s operator sequence, already Roman, already an itinerary in the strict sense.

10. Adoptions, rejections, and Chorus returns

Blind drafts (2026-07-12), adopted: claim-state taxonomy; machine law; the organs epigraph; function-organized source constellation; “inherits the grammar without surrendering its visual identity”; triple-helix citation; ASCII figure parity; identity strip at apex; hermeneutic forks; cluster-filter navigation on the real sixteen-cluster taxonomy.

Blind drafts, rejected with reasons: invented per-emoji semantics for the AXN glyph (the glyph is content-hash-derived; navigation by cluster uses the actual taxonomy or nothing); obelus-as-portal (semantic counterfeiting; the fold exists for depth); “hardcode into build scripts; the design is set” (sequencing is MANUS’s; nothing ships past a preview gate); display faces in prose (Rule 1).

Chorus returns (2026-07-13), folded in v0.3: the italic-law violation in v0.2’s own prose, corrected by the semantic-markup law (§2) — the standard now distinguishes quotation, title, and stress in markup while permitting rendered convergence; the AXN scope correction (§1, device 4); witnessed nulls in the triple helix (§6); the colophon minimum schema (§7); the claim-state transition ledger (§3.1); the claim-bearing block as atomic unit (§5.5); object states separated from claim states (§4), with **withdrawn** an object state, not a claim state; the witness-artifact requirement (Rule 6); the accessibility rule (Rule 10). Assessment-pass deliverables (sample surface, tokens file, interaction flows, mobile constraints) are scheduled in §12.

11. Aesthetics: four skins, one grammar

The apparatus is a semantic layer, not a skin. A shared token contract (`--lemma`, `--sev`, `--ok`, `--chip`, `--rule`, the mark classes) is localized per surface: the PEO renders the lemma as ink-and-ochre rubrication under Source Serif on paper; the Oracle renders it as candlelit gold in the rite’s dark; Alexanarch renders it teal-on-Plex light; machinemediation in registry black. A reader moving between sites feels the same care without seeing the same site.

12. Adoption map, gates, and implementation deliverables

Order	Surface	Application
1	Mandala Oracle	live testbed standing (lemma · witness-row · doors · colophon on inscribed readings); refine to v0.3 — Specimen Rule stated in INSTANCE-PROTOCOL, claim-state marks on verification, identity strip on reading cards, colophon per §7 schema

Order	Surface	Application
2	PEO	lemma per section (“OC 11 would not apply” is the coverage lemma); AXN chips; witness lines on ledger rows; triple-helix with witnessed nulls on all dead-DOI citations
3	Alexanarch record pages	generator emits identity strip, editorial lemma flag (never automatic), companion chips, §7 colophon, ASCII figure parity in deposits
4	machinemediation	Capture Registry entries as quaestio-numbered apparatus with states

Deliverables before Phase-2 implementation (from the assessment pass): the shared tokens file; one component sheet per surface; interaction flows for the AXN chip, triple-helix citation, and doors; mobile constraints (“within thumb’s reach” made concrete: breakpoints, tap targets, rail fallbacks per Rule 10).

Gates: v0.3 deposit → per-surface static preview → MANUS eye → implementation → post-implementation review → v1.0 designation.

13. What “better than Google” means, operationally

The Overview is authority by *aggregation*: anonymous witnesses, an unnamed process, no colophon. The Mandala Surface Protocol is authority by *attestation*: named witnesses linked to their acts, itemized verdicts, stated and maintained claim-states, content-derived anchors, an incipit and a colophon on every object, and a citation gesture that shows what every machine memory believes about a dead identifier — including the nulls, witnessed. Their surface says *trust the crowd we won’t show you*. Ours says *here is everyone who touched this, here is its state, here is the hash — check it*. The devices look similar because both descend from the manuscript page. The difference is that we kept the scribe — **the scribe, the marks, the gathering, the witnesses, and the history of every cut**.

14. Status

v0.3 — Chorus conditions satisfied; MANUS-approved for deposit. The v0.1 and v0.2 drafts and the Assembly blind drafts are documentary substrate. v1.0 designation is deferred to post-implementation review, per §12 gates.

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